

Εὐριπίδης

Euripides and the Tragic Stage of Classical Athens

eul_aid: cbm

Period: *Κλασική* [Classical](#)
Dialect: *Δράμα Ἀττικόν* [Attic Drama](#)
Domain: *Δρᾶμα* [Drama](#)
Format: *Ἑμμετρος* [Verse](#)

Euripides was a tragic playwright who lived in Athens during the 5th century BCE, from approximately 480 to 406 BCE. He was a contemporary of the other great Athenian dramatists, Sophocles and Aeschylus. His life coincided with the Peloponnesian War, a long and devastating conflict that influenced the themes in his work. According to ancient sources, he spent his final years at the court of King Archelaus in Macedon, where he died.

He wrote over 90 plays, and 19 of them survive today, which is more than any other ancient Greek tragedian. Among his most famous works are *Medea*, *The Trojan Women*, *The Bacchae*, and *Hippolytus*. The authorship of one surviving play, *Rhesus*, is disputed by scholars. Some of his final plays, like *Iphigenia at Aulis*, may have been completed after his death.

Euripides is considered one of the three foundational figures of Greek tragedy. Modern scholars note that his plays were innovative and often challenged traditional values. They are known for their complex, psychologically realistic characters, including powerful and sympathetic portraits of women. His work frequently engages with contemporary philosophical debates and can express a rationalistic critique of traditional myths and the gods.

Although he won fewer prizes in his lifetime than his rivals, his plays became immensely popular in the centuries after his death, profoundly influencing later Greek, Roman, and European drama.

Works (32)

- *Ἀλκηστις* · [Alcestis](#) · 1135 passages
- *Ἀλέξανδρος* · [Alexander](#) · 178 passages
- *Ἀνδρομάχη* · [Andromacha](#) · 1206 passages
- *Ἀντιόπη* · [Antiope](#) · 133 passages
- *Βάκχαι* · [Bacchae](#) · 1333 passages
- *Ἀποσπάσματα* · [Cassandra and Apollo Fragments](#) · 171 passages
- *Κύκλωψ* · [Cyclops](#) · 681 passages
- *Ἡλέκτρα* · [Electra](#) · 1304 passages
- *Ἐπιγράμματα* · [Epigrams](#) · 4 passages
- *Ἀποσπάσματα ἀδήλου διηγήσεως* · [Fragments of an Uncertain Story](#) · 14 passages
- *Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Φυγῆς καὶ Γένους* · [Fragments on Exile and Lineage](#) · 2833 passages

- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ἑκτορος καὶ Κασσάνδρας · Fragments on Hector and Cassandra](#) · 477 passages
- [Ἑκάβη · Hecuba](#) · 1206 passages
- [Ἑλένη · Helena](#) · 1652 passages
- [Ἡρακλεΐδαι · Heracleidae](#) · 1026 passages
- [Ἡρακλῆς · Hercules](#) · 1369 passages
- [Ἴππόλυτος · Hippolytus](#) · 1385 passages
- [Ὑψιπύλη · Hypsipyle](#) · 355 passages
- [Ἴων · Ion](#) · 1563 passages
- [Ἰφιγένεια ἐν Αὐλίδι · Iphigenia at Aulis](#) · 1573 passages
- [Ἰφιγένεια ἐν Ταύροις · Iphigenia in Tauris](#) · 1397 passages
- [Μήδεια · Medea](#) · 1335 passages
- [Οἶνεύς · Oeneus](#) · 32 passages
- [Ὀρέστης · Orestes](#) · 1630 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα παπύρου · Papyrus Fragments](#) · 584 passages
- [Φαέθων · Phaethon](#) · 124 passages
- [Φοίνισσαι · Phoenician Women](#) · 1687 passages
- [Φρίξος · Phrixus](#) · 98 passages
- [Ῥῆσος · Rhesus](#) · 951 passages
- [Ἰκέτιδες · Supplicants](#) · 1193 passages
- [Τρωάδες · Trojan Women](#) · 1267 passages
- [Νικητήριος ὥδῃ ἐπὶ Ἀλκιβιάδῃ · Victory Ode-Alcibiades](#) · 6 passages